

Identification

587

records identified
PubMed 234 · Scopus 326 · WoS 27 (new records)

Screening

587

records screened
(title, abstract, publication type)

231

excluded: reviews,
meta-analyses, editorials

356

primary studies
129 state accuracy in the abstract
227 do not (recall check, right)

90

plausible (title, abstract)
53 no open full text
3 not retrievable
34 full texts read

Eligibility

82

full texts read (48 abstract arm,
34 recall check)
77 studies, 251 estimates extracted

134

estimates set aside,
reason recorded

117

eligible estimates from 47 studies
case versus healthy control

Included

97

circulating estimates in the
primary meta-analysis, from
37 independent studies

20

not pooled
17 no computable
standard error
3 cerebrospinal fluid